

Accenture Management Challenge 2026

Team Ignite

Engineering Project Management

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Outline

- Initiating
- Stakeholders
- WBS
- RACI
- Gantt Chart
- Risk Management
- Conclusion and Lessons learned

Initiating

- **Project Objective** : Participate in the Global Management Challenge and achieve the best possible result by making informed, data-driven decisions each week.
- **Project Scope**: Analyse company performance, prepare and submit decisions for each simulation period, monitor outcomes, and deliver the final report and presentation within the challenge timeline.
- **Success Criteria**: Zero missed decision deadlines; positive team synergy ; correct application of PM techniques ; increase in enterprise "share quotes"; qualify for the final phase of the GMC.

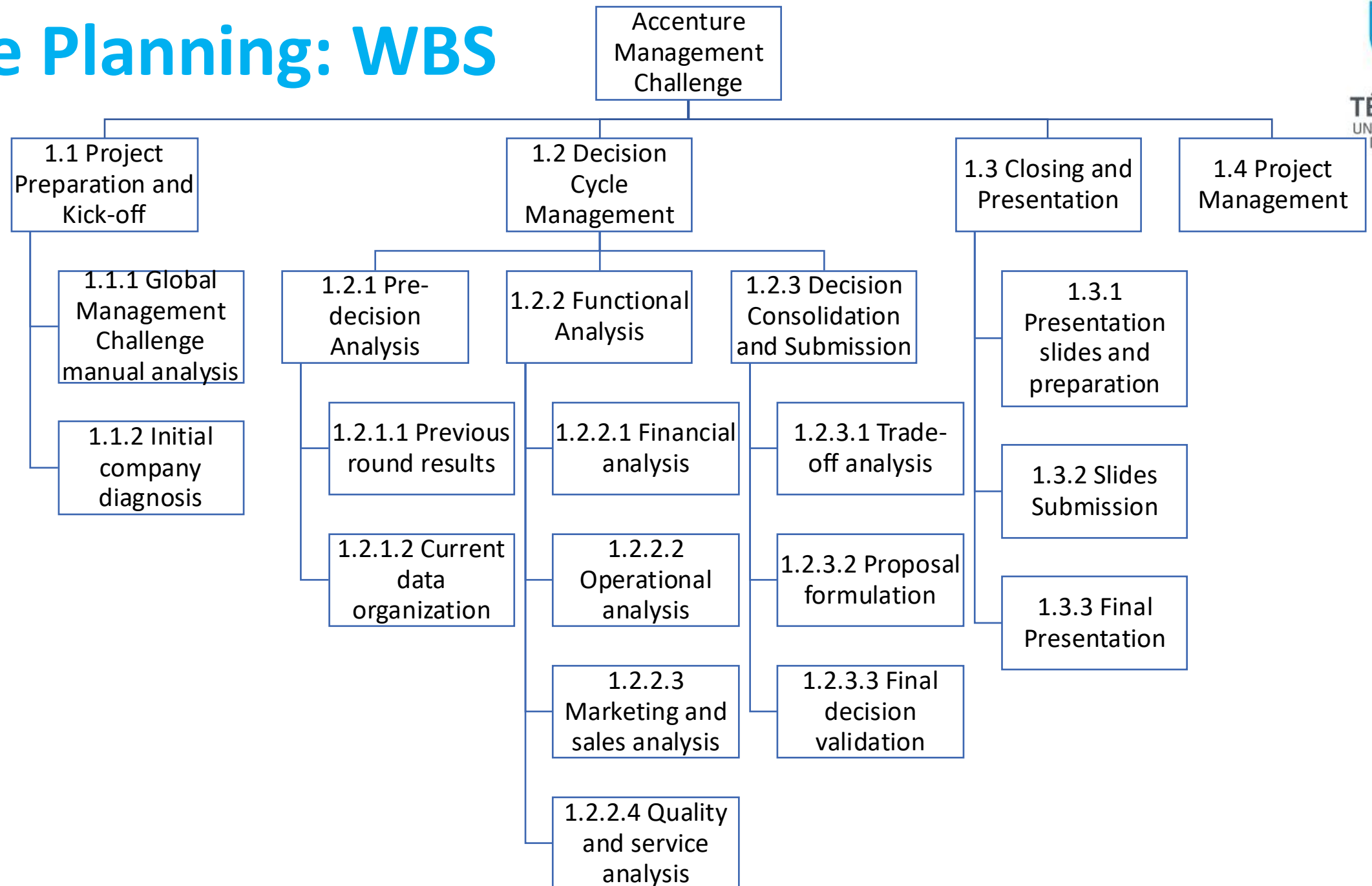
Stakeholders register

Stakeholder	Interests	Impact	Expectations	Attitudes/Risks	Communication
Project Team members	Achieve strong performance and apply Project Management techniques	Directly controls strategy, decisions and results	Clear roles, good coordination and timely decisions	Poor communication leading to misalignment in decision-making	Periodic in person meetings, shared decisions and deadlines
TOPAZ team	Ensure the simulation runs fairly and according to the rules	Provides the simulator, reports, calendar and decision sheets	Correct use of the platform and respect for deadlines	Technical server downtime and processing errors	Official calendar
Course Professors (Tânia Ramos, Beatriz Cassuriaga and Luís Correia): CUSTOMERS	Evaluate the project and student performance accordingly with PM methodologies	Define evaluation criteria and presentation format	Technical and analytical rigor behind each simulation decision	Risk of bad evaluation if guidelines and structure are not followed	Final presentation, rules and evaluation criteria
Accenture: SPONSOR	Promote business context and student engagement	Gives professional relevance to the challenge	Strategic thinking, teamwork, business mindset and qualifying for the Final Challenge	Risk of weak link between simulation and real business learning	Presentation, project outcomes and professional learning
Other student teams of group 3	Compete for the best share price and a place in the final competition	Influence ranking and market pressure	Competitive performance and adaptive strategy	Reacting in order to put competitors at a disadvantage	Ranking, market results and management reports

Initiating: Priorities & Constraints

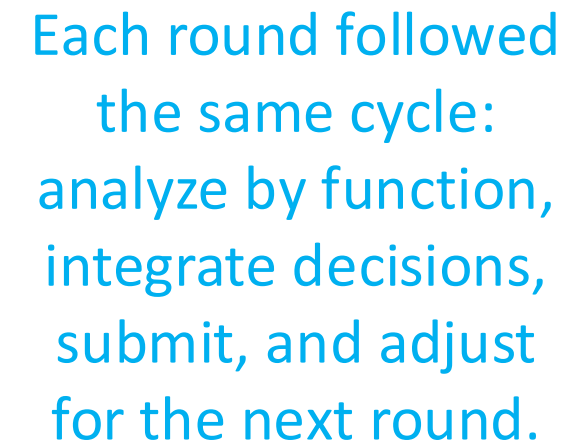
- **Customer Priorities:** Technical accuracy, adherence to PM methodology, and group cohesion.
- **Constraints:** Fixed competition timeline ; "Black Box" nature of the GMC simulator algorithm.
- **Initial assumptions:** All members have some knowledge of the GMC manual ; Assumed minimum of 2 hours of synchronous meeting time between each decision.
- **Deliverables:** Five intermediate decisions; Final presentation by the 7th of May.

Scope Planning: WBS

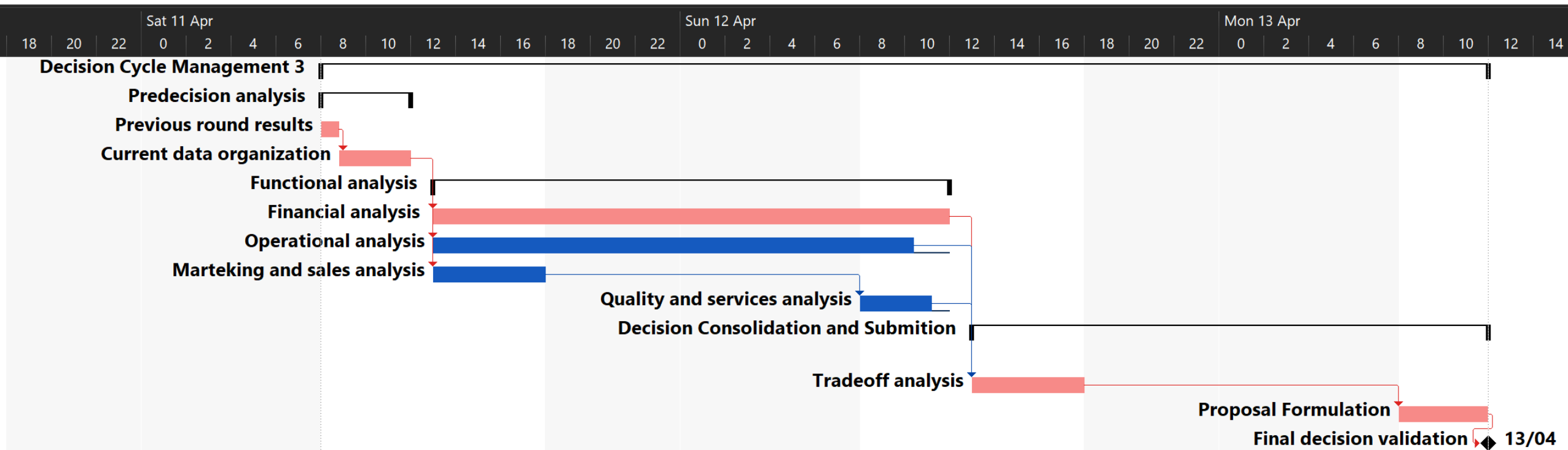


RACI Matrix

Activities	Project Manager	Financial Manager	Operational Manager	Marketing Manager	Quality & Services Manager
Initial company diagnosis	A	R	R	R	C
Financial analysis	A	R	I	I	I
Operational analysis	A	I	R	I	I
Marketing and sales analysis	A	I	I	R	I
Quality and service analysis	A	I	I	C	R
Trade-off analysis	A	R	R	R	R
Proposal formulation	A	R	R	R	R
Final decision and double checking	A	C	R	C	C
Presentation slides and preparation	A	C	C	R	R



Weekly Decision Workflow Gantt chart



Risk management

- **Project & Process Risks (Internal)**
 - **Resource Availability:** Incompatible timelines between members; Unexpected sickness from member responsible for critical task
 - **Communication Breakdown:** unresolvable conflict during a decision-making session; Mutually exclusive decisions
 - **Data Integrity:** The risk of a manual entry error
- **Mitigation and Response planning**
 - **Double-checking:** ensure revision by different project team members
 - **Buffer Scheduling:** deliverable readiness 13h before deadline
 - **Cross-functional coverage:** ensure any team member can step in if another is unexpectedly unavailable

Conclusions

HARVESTING & OUTCOMES

- Continuous review of management reports allowed us to harvest key insights and directly improve our strategic choices for future rounds.
- *We achieved 100% deadline compliance and positive team synergy.*

LESSONS LEARNED

- Data analysis was essential to navigate the "Black Box" nature of the simulator and avoid guessing.
- Relying on our RACI framework streamlined communication between different areas and prevented inconsistent strategy choices.
- Monitoring results after each round allowed us to adjust our approach dynamically.

CONCLUSION

Managing a company is not only about making isolated decisions. It requires aligning stakeholders, data, team members, time and strategy under external pressure.